

Crystals and gems

People have been attracted by the beauty of gemstones and crystals since the very earliest times and imbued them with the powers of magic and healing. The first written reference to the use of crystals for magic dates back to ancient Sumer before 3000 BCE, while the ancient Egyptians used lapis lazuli, turquoise, carnelian, emeralds, and clear quartz for rituals to promote protection and health—as do New Age crystal healers today.



▲ **Ruby** is associated with energy, action, hope, and increasing motivation and passion. It is also said to strengthen the heart both physically and emotionally.



▲ **Sapphire** is linked with the third eye (a sign of enlightenment in non-Western traditions and New Age). Early popes wore sapphires in signet rings to signify that they guarded holy secrets.



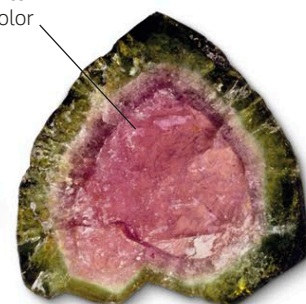
▲ **Agate** is widely used for healing and magic and is associated with health, intelligence, and longevity. It is made of microscopic crystals of silica and quartz, and is easily carved into shapes.



▲ **Emerald** was linked to Aphrodite, the goddess of love (called Venus in ancient Rome) by the ancient Greeks, and the stone is still said to bring love into people's life.



▲ **Citrine** is a form of quartz. Its color connects it to the power of the sun, and it is believed to confer positive energy, new beginnings, and willpower.



▲ **Tourmaline** is said to foster compassion and peace. It also gives off an electric charge when heated or rubbed, a quality highly valued by alchemists.



Garnets stand for regeneration

This rich, dark stone color is known as imperial jade

The elephant is a symbol of good fortune in China

▲ **Jade** is believed to have calming, protective powers and has been used as a healing agent as far back as 10,000 BCE. The term *jade* refers to one of two minerals—nephrite and jadeite; this Chinese vase is made of nephrite.

Impurities at the center create the pink color